ASHWINI CHAUDHARY

CTO | I run product and engineering as one team, with AI across the whole company

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PROFILE

I'm at my best when I own a problem end to end, and I tend to take on whatever is slowing the company down, whether or not it's in my job description. I start from the business problem, pick the bet, decide how we'll know it worked, and build it with the team, often with my own hands. As CTO at Diversio I led the pivot to Optimo and took it from internal launch to paying customers, made AI part of everyday work for sales, customer success and marketing as well as engineering, and completed SOC 2 Type 2 while cutting cloud costs by about two-thirds. 13+ years across backend, payments, platform and security before that.

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer

Diversio Inc

Jul 2024 – Present Toronto

- **New product, new market.** Led Diversio's pivot to Optimo, from internal launch (Nov 2025) to paying customers and pilots. I own the roadmap with customer success and sales, and still ship features myself.
- **AI across the company.** On my own initiative, built Courage, an AI teammate in Slack and GitHub used by sales, customer success, and consulting as well as engineering. In its first month it handled about 3,800 requests, reviewed 840+ PRs, and opened 87, and it now runs most of our old manual processes. People approve every change that matters.
- **Review stopped being the bottleneck.** Getting good human reviews used to slow every release. Our own AI reviewer has done 4,700+ reviews across 1,150+ PRs against our standards, so humans review what actually needs judgment, with AI spend kept low.
- **AI in the product, with privacy built in.** Set Optimo's AI direction and shipped Lumi, an AI assistant for managers, designed so no individual's data reaches AI providers. Moved clients' sensitive HR files off email into a secure exchange in the product.
- **Trust as a selling point.** Ran our first SOC 2 Type 2 end to end as the main contact with the auditor: wrote the security policies, did the vendor reviews and risk register, and automated most evidence capture with AI agents. Launched a public Trust Center with a staff guide, so sales and customer success can answer security requests without engineering.
- **Lean by default.** Cut our AWS bill by about two-thirds in a year, brought CI costs to almost zero since February by moving checks onto our own local CI, and cut deploys from 8–13 minutes to about 2.5. A small team ships around three backend releases a week.
- **Beyond the job description.** As the team got smaller, took on compliance, IT, vendor negotiations, hiring and onboarding, and hands-on help for sales and customer success. When our cloud dev-environment vendor shut down, moved those environments onto spare in-house hardware at no added cost.
- **Teaching the company.** Run weekly sessions, write guides, and gave a company town hall talk on working with AI agents, so

HOW I WORK

- Tie every bet to a business number before building
- Ship small, measure, and cut what doesn't move it
- Put AI where people already work, with a person approving what matters
- Hire for skill shown live, and give people real ownership
- Pick up whatever is slowing the company down, in my lane or not

CORE STACK

TypeScript, Python, Go, Rust, Django, Postgres, AWS, Terraform, Docker, Redis, Pi, Claude Code, Codex, MCP, Linux, and Git.

THINGS I BUILT

Courage
AI teammate for the whole company on Pi Durable, in Slack, GitHub, and the CLI (Claude Code, Pi).

little-person
Automated PR reviewer on Temporal. 4,700+ reviews on 1,150+ PRs.

Lumi
Optimo's AI assistant for managers on web and Slack, with a performance review helper.

Dev Center & local-ci
Worktree dev environments (Rust) and local CI (Go).

Cineplex Seat Watcher
Alerts for specific seats and new showtimes. Live.

RECOGNITION

- Stack Overflow: 252K reputation, 3,700+ answers, ranked #287 overall.
- Unsplash: 218M+ views, 1.3M+ downloads, and top 1000 on the platform.
- Arctic Code Vault Contributor.
- Won Instamojo's hackathon for building a payments-powered vending machine.

WRITING

the whole team, not just engineers, gets value from them. I also write publicly about how we work.
- Team. Hire and mentor engineers and co-ops (UofT, Queen's, Waterloo) through skill-based live interviews, and built the developer tooling the team runs on, including open-source local CI.

Head of Engineering
Diversio Inc

Jul 2023 – Jun 2024 Toronto

- Engineering on the leadership team. Owned technical strategy, architecture, and vendor decisions end to end, reporting to the CEO and COO and shaping the product roadmap with our PMs.
- Two companies, one platform. After Diversio acquired CCDI Consulting, led the consolidation of both platforms and tech stacks into one.
- Growing people. Over the years, hired, led, and mentored 20+ engineers, contractors, and co-op students in total, and helped many of them grow into stronger engineers and further in their careers.

Lead Engineer
Diversio Inc

Aug 2019 – Jun 2023 Toronto / Remote

- Leadership team from day one. Joined as an early engineer reporting directly to the CEO and COO, and owned technical direction, architecture, and vendors from the start.
- Every major launch and revamp. Led engineering on every major Diversio product launch and revamp, managed a contract team in Poland alongside the in-house engineers, and represented engineering with clients.
- Platform and security. Owned infrastructure, deployments, and production, and led Diversio's first SOC 2 and multiple pen-test rounds.

Software Engineer
Unhaggle Inc

Nov 2017 – Feb 2021 Remote

- Owned infrastructure, site reliability, and deployments for the Dealer team.

Senior Software Engineer
Instamojo

Mar 2015 – Oct 2017 Bengaluru

- Built Instamojo's e-commerce plugins and SDKs across WordPress, Magento, Drupal, Python, Ruby, and PHP.
- Delivered KYC onboarding, the Orders API, gateway integrations, and automated refunds.

Python Developer
Simform Solutions

Sep 2013 – Feb 2015 Ahmedabad

- Built SentMap's real-time market data backend (Node.js, Socket.IO).
- Claude Code features you may not have tried yet
- All tools should now have two users
- How we use AI like engineers
- No code by hand
- Protecting our own tenant in a multi-tenant SaaS

OPEN SOURCE

- Contributed to typeshed, mypy, django-debug-toolbar, pep8speaks, pgmpy, and others.
- Public tools: auto-uv-env, microverse, wt, ew, pi-cmux, clickup-mcp, local-ci-runner, and the Diversio agent skills marketplace.
- Spoke at MUPy and coached at Django Girls Bangalore.

EDUCATION

B.Tech. in IT
IMS Engineering College

2009 – 2013 Ghaziabad

LINKS

ashwch.com
github.com/ashwch
linkedin.com/in/ashwch
Stack Overflow
Unsplash